

A Choice That Has a Cost: A Missing Voice

有代价的选择：缺席的声音

Theme: 心理、决策、责任与人生选择 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The missing voice belonged to a **clown** at the children's **ceremony during** the **settlement** week. "You **never** asked the **age** of the people who will live **under** this roof," he said. "You have a **purpose** and a **vote**, and you have not asked whether the house is **impossible** to heat."

The **apparent** answer was **attractive: select** a smaller unit, **choose** a **cautious** price, and **forget** the rest. "**Sorrow** is not a **clinical** condition," he said, "and a **guidance** note is not **counsel**." A **stir** in the hall made the **identification** of the real problem **evident**: there was no **equality** in the plan.

The **equality** he meant was measured in decades. "A **materialist** reads a house as an asset," he said. "A **materialist** should also read it as a lifetime." His **idealism**, he admitted, was cheerful and his **realism** was not; the **seeming** contradiction was the whole of his argument.

The **solidity** of the building was **never** in doubt, and the **eternity** of a mortgage was. "You can **visualize** a family in it, and you cannot **visualize** a family paying for it," he said. "A **clear-cut** plan would say who repays and when."

The **blame** for the confusion lay with the **guidance**, not with the family. "A **cautious** buyer and a cheating seller can look alike on paper," Maya wrote. "The difference is the second page." The voice he raised was **mad** by their standards and **just** by his own.

The **settlement** was revised by one clause: every unit would be sold with a heating assessment attached. It was almost nothing, and it was nearly everything, and the group agreed to appear at the next meeting with the figure. They agreed almost at once, and I nearly said nothing. We need a similar kind of free claim, and a true history is not a chapter that dies. A kind moment, an image, and a win were not enough while nearly half the residents were absent. The break in the plan appeared as a missing page, and almost everyone who could **vote** did; the need was similar to the earlier survey. We must **decide** whether the dead **govern** us; a house is **alive** in a way that **materialism** cannot **visualise**, and the **death** of the old plan did not settle the question. The **settlement** would **visualise** the cost instead.

中文翻译

那个缺席的声音属于安置周期间儿童典礼上的一个小丑。“你们从来没有问过将要住在这个屋顶下的人的年龄，”他说，“你们有一个目的和一次表决，而你们没有问过这栋房子是不是无法取暖。”

表面的答案是吸引人的：选一个更小的单元、挑一个谨慎的价格，其余的忘掉。“悲伤不是一种临床状态，”他说，“一份指导说明不是法律顾问。”大厅里一阵骚动让真正问题的身份变得明显：这份方案里没有平等。

他所说的平等是以十年为单位计量的。“唯物主义者把房子读成一项资产，”他说，“唯物主义者也应该把它读成一辈子。”他承认，他的理想主义是欢快的，而他的现实主义不是；这个表面上的矛盾就是他论证的全部。

这栋楼的坚固性从未被怀疑，而被怀疑的是一笔按揭的永恒。“你可以在里面想象一个家庭，却无法想象一个家庭在付它的钱，”他说，“一份明确的方案会说明谁偿还、何时偿还。”

混乱该归咎于那份指导，而不是那个家庭。“一个谨慎的买家和一个作弊的卖家在纸上看起来可以很像，”曼雅写道，“区别在第二页。”他提高的嗓音按他们的标准是疯狂的，按他自己的标准是公正的。

安置方案因一条条款而被修改：每个单元出售时都必须附一份取暖评估。这几乎什么都不是，也几乎就是一切，而小组同意带着这个数字出现在下次会议上。他们几乎立刻就同意了，而我几乎什么也没说。我们需要一种类似的、自由的诉求，而一部真实的历史不是一章会死去的东西。在将近一半居民缺席的时候，一个善意的时刻、一张图像和一场胜利都不够。方案里的断裂以一张缺页的形式出现，而几乎所有能投票的人都投了；这种需要与早先那次调查相似。我们必须决定死者是否在统治我们；一栋房子是活的，其方式唯物主义无法想象，而旧计划的死亡并没有解决这个问题。这份安置方案将转而把代价想象出来。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
just dʒʌst POS: a	a. 正直的, 合理的, 正确的, 应得的; adv. 刚刚, 正好, 仅仅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. used especially of what is legally or ethically right or proper or fitting; r. only a moment ago; r. absolut...
never 'neve POS: adv	adv. 从不, 决不, 不曾; [法] 永不, 决不, 从来没有 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. not ever; at no time in the past or future; r. not at all; certainly not; not in any circumstances
under 'ʌndə POS: prep	prep. 在...之下, 低于; a. 下面的, 从属的; adv. 在下面 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. lower in rank, power, or authority; r. down to defeat, death, or ruin; r. through a range downward; r. into u...
during 'djʊəriŋ POS: prep	prep. 在...的时候 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. In the time of; as long as the action or existence of;; as, during life; during the space of a year.
age eidʒ POS: n	n. 年龄, 老年, 成年, 寿命, 时代, 时期; v. 变老, 成熟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. how long something has existed; n. a time of life (usually defined in years) at which some particular quali...
decide di'said POS: v	v. 决定, 判决 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. reach, make, or come to a decision about something; v. bring to an end; settle conclusively; v. cause to dec...
death deθ POS: n	n. 死亡; [医] 死亡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the event of dying or departure from life; n. the permanent end of all life functions in an organism or par...
choose tʃu:z POS: vt	vt. 选择, 宁愿, 欲; vi. 作出选择, 愿意; [计] 选取 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. pick out, select, or choose from a number of alternatives; v. select as an alternative over another; v. see...
purpose 'pə:pəs POS: n	n. 目的, 意向, 决心, 用途, 效果, 论题; vt. 意欲, 企图, 计划 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an anticipated outcome that is intended or that guides your planned actions; v. reach a decision
forget fə'get POS: vt	vt. 忘记, 忽略, 忘; vi. 忘记 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. dismiss from the mind; stop remembering; v. be unable to remember; v. forget to do something; v. leave behind...
vote vəʊt POS: n	n. 投票, 选举, 选票, 表决, 选举权, 得票数; vi. 投票, 选举; vt. 投票选举, 投票决定, 公认, 使投票 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a choice that is made by counting the number of people in favor of each alternative; n. the opinion of a gr...
impossible im'pɒsəbl POS: a	a. 不可能的, 难以置信的, 令人无法忍受的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that cannot be done; a. not capable of occurring or being accomplished or dealt with; s. totally u...
alive ə'laɪv POS: a	a. 活着的, 活泼的, 敏感的, 热闹的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. possessing life; s. (often followed by 'with') full of life and spirit; s. (followed by 'to' or 'of') aware...
settlement 'setlment POS: n	n. 安顿, 解决, 处理, 结算, 殖民, 殖民地, 沉降; [医] 居住区; 沉渣 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a conclusive resolution of a matter and disposition of it; n. something settled or resolved; the outcome of...
select si'lekt POS: a	a. 挑选出来的, 极好的; v. 选择, 挑选; n. 被挑选者, 精萃; [计] 选定 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v pick out, select, or choose from a number of alternatives; s of superior grade; s selected or chosen for spec...
apparent ə'pærənt POS: a	a. 清晰可见的, 显然的, 表面上的; [电] 外在的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. clearly revealed to the mind or the senses or judgment; s. appearing as such but not necessarily so
attractive ə'træktɪv POS: a	a. 吸引人的, 有魅力的; [法] 有吸引力的, 有迷惑力的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. pleasing to the eye or mind especially through beauty or charm; s. having power to arouse interest; a. havin...
blame bleɪm POS: n	n. 过失, 责备; vt. 责备, 归咎于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a reproach for some lapse or misdeed; v. put or pin the blame on; v. harass with constant criticism; v. attri...
stir steɪ POS: n	n. 骚动, 轰动, 搅动, 监狱; vt. 移动, 摇动, 激起, 惹起, 搅拌; vi. 走动, 传播, 搅拌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a prominent or sensational but short-lived news event; n. emotional agitation and excitement; v. move an imp...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
mad mæd POS: a	a. 疯狂的, 发疯的, 生气的, 愚蠢的, 狂欢的; n. 狂怒 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s roused to anger; s affected with madness or insanity; s marked by uncontrolled excitement or emotion; s very f...
clinical 'klinikəl POS: a	a. 临床的, 门诊部的; [医] 临床的, 临证的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to a clinic or conducted in or as if in a clinic and depending on direct observation of patients; ...
guidance 'gaɪdn̩s POS: n	n. 指导, 领导; [医] 导 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that provides direction or advice as to a decision or course of action; n. the act of guiding or ...
ceremony 'seriməni POS: n	n. 典礼, 仪式, 礼节; [法] 典礼, 仪式 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a formal event performed on a special occasion; n. any activity that is performed in an especially solemn e...
evident 'evidənt POS: a	a. 显然的, 明显的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s clearly revealed to the mind or the senses or judgment; s capable of being seen or noticed
govern 'gʌvən POS: v	v. 统治, 支配, 管理 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. direct or strongly influence the behavior of; v. exercise authority over; as of nations; v. require to be in...
identification ai.dentifi'keɪʃən POS: n	n. 识别, 身份证明, 认同; [化] 鉴定; 鉴别; 鉴别法; 认证 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. evidence of identity; something that identifies a person or thing; n. the condition of having the identity...
counsel 'kaʊnsəl POS: n	n. 商议, 忠告, 法律顾问; v. 商议, 劝告 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a lawyer who pleads cases in court; n something that provides direction or advice as to a decision or course...
equality i:'kwɒləti POS: n	n. 平等, 均匀, 相等; [法] 同等, 平等, 相等 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being the same in quantity or measure or value or status; n. a state of being essentially eq...
cheat tʃi:t POS: n	n. 欺骗, 作弊, 骗子; v. 欺骗, 逃脱, 骗取 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a deception for profit to yourself; v. deprive somebody of something by deceit; v. defeat someone through tr...
cautious 'kɔ:ʃəs POS: a	a. 谨慎的, 小心的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. showing careful forethought; never making swift decisions"; s. avoiding excess
repay ri'pei POS: v	v. 偿还, 报答, 报复 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v pay back; v make repayment for or return something; v act or give recompense in recognition of someone's beha...
realism 'riəlɪzəm POS: n	n. 写实主义, 现实, 实在论; [法] 现实主义 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the attribute of accepting the facts of life and favoring practicality and literal truth; n. (philosophy) t...
sorrow 'spɹəʊ POS: n	n. 悲伤, 哀惜, 不幸; vi. 悲伤, 懊悔, 遗憾 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an emotion of great sadness associated with loss or bereavement; n. sadness associated with some wrong done...
clown klaʊn POS: n	n. 小丑, 乡下人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a rude or vulgar fool; n. a person who amuses others by ridiculous behavior; v. act as or like a clown
eternity i'te:nɪti POS: n	n. 永远, 来世, 不朽 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. time without end; n. a state of eternal existence believed in some religions to characterize the afterlife; ...
imposing im'pəʊzɪŋ POS: a	a. 令人难忘的, 壮丽的, 威风的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v compel to behave in a certain way; v impose something unpleasant; v impose and collect; s impressive in appear...
visualize 'vɪʒʊəlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使看得见, 使具体化, 想象, 设想; vi. 想象, 显形 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. imagine; conceive of; see in one's mind; v. view the outline of by means of an X-ray; v. form a mental pictu...
idealism aɪ'diəlɪzəm POS: n	n. 唯心主义, 观念论, 唯心论, 理想主义 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (philosophy) the philosophical theory that ideas are the only reality; n. impracticality by virtue of think...
visualise 'vɪzjəlaɪz, -ʒjə- POS: vi/vt	vt. 使可见, 使具体化, 使具形象; vt.vi. 设想, 想象; vi. 显现 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v view the outline of by means of an X-ray; v form a mental picture of something that is invisible or abstract...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
seeming 'si:miŋ POS: a	a. 表面上的; n. 外观 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v give a certain impression or have a certain outward aspect; v seem to be true, probable, or apparent; v appea...
materialism mə'tiəriəlizm POS: n	n. 唯物主义 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a desire for wealth and material possessions with little interest in ethical or spiritual matters; n. (phil...
materialist mə'tiəriəlist POS: n	n. 唯物主义者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. someone with great regard for material possessions; n. someone who thinks that nothing exists but physical...
solidity sə'liditi POS: n	n. 固体性, 坚硬, 坚固, 稳健, 体积 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the consistency of a solid; n. state of having the interior filled with matter; n. the quality of being soli...
clear-cut phonetic unavailable POS: a	a. 轮廓清晰的, 明确的, 清楚的; [法] 清晰的, 明确的, 轮廓清楚的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. remove all the trees at one time; s. clearly or sharply defined to the mind; s. having had all the trees rem...